Preface to the Rails 8 Edition

Rails 7.2 was released in August of 2024. Rails 8.0 rc1 was released in October. As such, there are few changes to the core in this edition. The biggest focus of this release is to make your application easier to deploy without requiring a full staff of DevOps engineers.

Chapter 17, *Task L: Deployment and Production* has been rewritten to reflect this. The introduction to Dockerfiles is still there, but the story continues on to show how to deploy your application to a cloud provider with a single command. And it continues further to show how to back up your data and send your logs to a service where they can be searched.

The biggest non-deployment related change is the introduction of a basic authentication generator.[1] This replaces much of the content of Chapter 14, *Task I: Logging In*, with something that does much more with much less code. The code generated by this generator makes use of Active Job and Active Mailer, further demonstrating how these components work together.

Minor changes include `text_area` being renamed to `textarea` [2] and `Parameters#expect` replaces most usages of `Parameters#require`.[3] and the upgrade to Tailwind CSS 4.0.[4]

I also elected to introduce some concepts earlier. Previous editions started with a basic web application and then added features like Active Job, Active Storage, and Turbo Streams. A perennial theme of Rails is compressing complexity, and given that these features can now be demonstrated with